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Pssst...

Spring Training's Here Again

By Halsey Hall

Sunday Tribune Staff Writer

THERE WAS the time Mike Kelly pulled the whole Miller baseball team out of their hotel at midnight and sent them scurrying to find places to sleep.

The reason: The hotel served Mike a second-rate ham sandwich.

And there was the time

that New York Giant Jim Thorpe floored four Boston Red Sox, including Babe Ruth, in a wild melee after a spiking incident.

And there were 25 men in a jail—prison, jail—on a sunny spring day in 1931 at the old Eastman hotel in Hot Springs, Ark.

And, as in the old nursery rhyme, attendees went rrrr-rub-rub-rub-rub.

managing legs, backs and arms. Minneapolis Miller baseball trainer Frank (Doc) Bowman looked on the mass bathing scene and almost moaned as he remarked:

Yeah. Look at 'em. It's the lead to take these baths here. I'd do them just about as much good if they'd only bathe every day at home. But try to get a guy in his OWN tub every day!"

THE BATHS at Hot Springs, then, the dog or horse races there or somewhere else, fishing, golfing, tennis, night clubs, the social whirl. Or, if your manager is a martinet, nothing but walking.

It's all part of the joyous games that is spring training, an American baseball institution that is as vital a part of the national scheme as the World Series. Training starts the season. The Series ends it; each episode has its highlights and lowlights.

Jealousy started it all 87 years ago. The year before, the Cincinnati Red Stockings had gone undefeated and one Tom Foley of Chicago became jealous.

He set out to do something about it. He rounded up the best players he could find and, seeking an early conditioning start, dragged the gang down to New Orleans for some early training.

WELL, SIR, that was it. The Chicago White Stockings were the first to go south and, when they succeeded in defeating Cincinnati that year, many old National Association teams decided New Orleans in March and April was for them, too.

Strictly second class on the whole, you understand. Second rate hotels, ordinary grub. But a start had been made and improvement was certain.

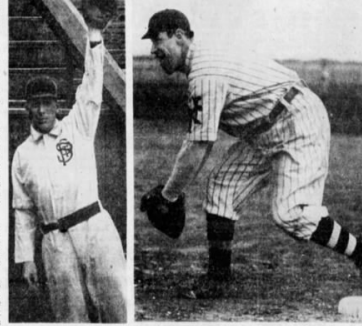
Connie Mack went south with Washington in 1880. To Jacksonville, Fla. The boys rode two-to-a-berth at night, switched to coaches in the daytime. Then they found no hotel wanted any part of them until one hotelier took them in for the definite stipulation that "the ballplayers must not mix with the other guests or eat in the same dining room."

NOWADAYS the swankiest hotels vie for the players' patronage. And travel? Why, bless you, one year all three New York teams—Giants, Yankees and Dodgers—trained and played games in Puerto Rico, Venezuela.

Here it was that a dan-



CONNIE MACK SPRANG UP, BAT IN HAND, AT CELEBRATION



MIKE KELLEY In his playing days

THE GREAT CARLISLE INDIAN, JIM THORPE He played baseball under John J. McGraw as a Giant

Cuba, Panama and Hawaii.

The Millers are at the Mayfair Inn in Sanford, Fla., owned by the Giants who run a beautiful spot with good service and excellent food. When old Joe Castillon had the club in the teens, however, it was Hickman, Ky., a dilapidated field and the favored players putting up in Joe's lodge on Reeffoot lake.

contracted a weakness that, a year or so later, led to tuberculosis and the passing of the character many considered to be the greatest southpaw of all time.

Possibly Sarasota, Fla., owes its success to two entertainment gentlemen—contract magnate John King and Giant manager John McGraw. They went

Baseball

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I LIKE IT HERE

by
GEORGE GRIM



CAN YOU ever know the sudden release from months—years—of tension, of sleepless hours, of gnawing worry? No matter what lies ahead, can you absorb the impact of words, spoken for the first time, "We think she'll be all right?"

John Taddoe met Lily, the girl he married, in Glasgow, Scotland. He was a GI, then. Ahead were plans to be a teacher.

Those plans worked out. He taught at Niagara Falls, N. Y., in a public school. There are two Taddoe youngsters, Sheila, 8, and Ian, 10. If the story just stopped there, you'd say "Fine, but what's different?"

Sheila's heart was different. For all her eight years, it was apparent that something was wrong. As she grew, the necessity for a critical operation became greater. John had heard of the surgical wonders performed at University hospitals, in Minneapolis. After an exchange of letters, of doctors' diagnoses, John took a night job in a factory. He wanted to add whatever he could to the daytime school teaching pay.

ABOUT A MONTH ago, leaving son Ian with friends in Niagara Falls, John, Lily and young Sheila came to Minneapolis. The youngster was placed in University hospitals. Her parents found a room nearby on Washington avenue.

They had been told that fresh blood would be needed for the operation. Blood banks aren't of help in these operations—the donors must stand by. At Mayflower Community church, the Rev. Jack Takayangi, minister to youth, tried to find people whose blood type would match that of little Sheila.

But did HE get into this story?

A distant relative of the Taddoe family is pastor of a church at Fulton, N. Y. He remembered working, at one time in Utica, N. Y., with pastor Takayangi. He also recalled that his friend was associated with a Minneapolis church. There was the

ask.

THE MAYFLOWER church bulletin made an appeal for fresh blood donors, with little Sheila's not-too-common blood type. There were three who could volunteer. Mrs. Alan Nussbaum, member of Mayflower, brought the church notice to her husband's attention. He, in turn, put it in the plant

newspaper at Minneapolis Honeywell, where he does research. Seven more donors came forward.

Day before the operation, the tension became double for John Taddoe and his wife. Of the ten donors, only six could be used. (Rejection rate is very high in this precise and delicate blood typing.) The operation would have to be postponed unless more volunteers were found.

The Taddoes had been waiting in Minneapolis for operation day for almost a month. The building of tension had been insupportable. Now, suddenly, what to do?

That's when Nussbaum phoned me. I talked with John Taddoe, then put the question to the boys at the naval air reserve, naval air station at Wold-Chamberlain field.

AT ONCE, there were responses. To the hospital, at operation time, went Seaman Donald P. Martin, Jack W. Lindquist, petty officer; 2c, Minneapolis; Richard J. Silviny, petty officer; 2c, St. Paul. Their blood was used. A fourth member of the station keepers group, Clarence R. Duckett, petty officer; 3c, Minneapolis, was rejected at the hospital—he had been receiving blood, intelligible.

From Friday until Monday night, Sheila was in the post operative section of the hospital. Her father and mother, not daring to go home, sat outside. The operation had been made doubly dangerous because of a lung difficulty, necessitating a tube to help the child breathe.

"The tenderness of the doctors and nurses was beyond belief," said John Taddoe. "If their own child had been in that room, they couldn't have been more understanding."

ON MONDAY night, for the first time since the operation, John and Lily Taddoe were back in that boarding house. The word from the doctors had been optimistic. They thought Sheila would be all right.

Ahead will be months, perhaps years, of extra work for John Taddoe when his school teaching day is finished.

"Who counts anything when the child may be well again?" he asks.

Who—including those donors from Mayflower church, Honeywell, the naval air station—the doctors and nurses at University hospitals—Who, indeed?

Lake Agassiz? Good Fishing for Relics

Along about this time of year, as February starts running out, I begin searching among Minnesota's 10,000 lakes for a new one to visit on my vacation.

Then I get to thinking about Ernie Reif. Ernie was Minnesota's greatest part-time archaeologist. He collected stone age relics and early Indian arrowheads into the inside of a woman's handbag. He had more junk—parian—artifacts than you could shake a medicine rolling pin at.

Well, in the process of gathering all these things, Ernie had heard about Lake Agassiz. It was usually mentioned whenever good archaeologists got together with a



rumorstone on the table and a good song ringing clear. It seemed to be a place rich in prehistoric backtracks.

So one spring Ernie and his wife, Thora, set out for Lake Agassiz.

He knew vaguely that it was up that way, around he couldn't find it on anybody's road map.

But they drove up past Mile Lake, and around Leech lake, asking gas station men along the way. None of 'em had ever heard of the place.

Then in Bemidji, Ernie ran into a scholar. "Where yuh goin', huh?" asked this scholar.

"On my way to a vacation on Lake Agassiz," said Ernie.

"Lake Agassiz?" said the scholar. "Boy, are you all in gear, Jimmie!"

"There was a fellow here from the museum last summer and he told me about that lake. Been dried up since just before the glaciers left."

Then the scholar told Ernie how in those days Minnesota was the Land of ONE Lake. Matter of fact, Minnesota wasn't land at all—just the bottom of prehistoric Lake Agassiz. And you can see the outline today if you know what you're looking for and get high enough.

I mean, of course, high enough in a plane.

Ernie found out when he got back to learn that Lake Agassiz had dried up about 1400 years after the glaciers went back home.

And the man down at the Museum of Natural History tells me that was 25,000 years ago.

Let's see . . . that would make it 20,000 years since this lake existed.

So Ernie and Thora were just 19,963 years late for an outing on Lake Agassiz.

Because, you see, all this happened back in 1920—37 years ago this spring.

You talk about frustrations! The other day three men in Elmwood Park, Ill., set out to rob a bank and found the front door was closed. They couldn't get in and had to drop the whole idea. Oh, well, if they had got in they probably would have found some fool had locked the safe.

You may have caught up with it, but I just heard a show-off described as "such a ham he uses a clove for a collar button."

GEORGE GRIM'S GLOBE-TROTTING GAME

Match the Face and Place

FUN FOR THE WHOLE FAMILY—PART 2—CLIP AND SAVE



MATCH THE DRAWINGS WITH THE FACES AND NAME THE COUNTRY		
Choose from this list:		
United States	Canada	Sweden
Korea	Russia	Germany
China	Panama	Mexico
Yugoslavia	Italy	Brazil

WIN A CONERAMA WONDER TRIP FOR TWO VIA SAS

1. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

2. The drawing of a man in a military uniform is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

3. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

4. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

5. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

6. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

7. The drawing of a man in a suit and tie is a portrait of a famous person. Match it with the face in the grid above.

Later Starters! Part One of 'MATCH THE FACE AND PLACE' Is in the Upper Midwest Section